Team Topology Design

Design teams around the flow of value: team types, how they interact, and how much each team can hold.

Coordinate Teams · Inspired by Team Topologies (Skelton & Pais) · Cognitive Load · Interaction Modes

LEGEND

- Yellow Sticky = A team
- Pink Sticky = Pain point

1 Team Types

MOST TEAMS SHOULD BE STREAM-ALIGNED

Stream-aligned

Owns a flow of work end to end: a product, journey or customer segment. Delivers value directly.

Our teams of this type:

Platform

Provides internal services that stream-aligned teams use self-service, reducing their load.

Our teams of this type:

Enabling

Helps other teams build new skills or adopt practices, for a while, then steps back.

Our teams of this type:

Complicated subsystem

Owns a part needing deep specialist knowledge, so others don't have to.

Our teams of this type:

2 Team Map

PLACE TEAMS · DRAW HOW THEY INTERACT

One yellow sticky per team, grouped by value stream

Collaboration · work closely, for a time

X-as-a-Service · use with little contact

Facilitating · help and coach

3 Cognitive Load Check

CAN EACH TEAM HOLD WHAT IT OWNS?

TEAM	DOMAINS & SYSTEMS OWNED	LOAD L/M/H	TOO MUCH?

4 Interaction Agreements

EVERY COLLABORATION HAS AN END DATE

TEAM A	TEAM B	MODE	PURPOSE	REVIEW BY

5 Changes to Try

"Which team is carrying more than it can hold?"

"If we redrew one team boundary, which dependency would disappear?"

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